

Perishables Handling and Carrier Guide

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1. Purpose

Some of the products that Northwind Traders sells must stay cold from the Seattle warehouse to the customer's door. This guide assigns every product category to a storage class, and states which carriers may carry it and how long it may be in transit.

2. Storage class by product category

The storage class of a product follows from its category in the product master.

CategoryID	Category	Storage class	Temperature	Permitted carriers	Maximum transit
1	Beverages	Ambient	Not controlled	Speedy Express, United Package, Federal Shipping	10 days
2	Condiments	Ambient	Not controlled	Speedy Express, United Package, Federal Shipping	10 days
3	Confections	Ambient	Not controlled	Speedy Express, United Package, Federal Shipping	10 days
4	Dairy Products	Chilled	2 to 6 °C	Speedy Express, United Package	5 days
5	Grains/Cereals	Ambient	Not controlled	Speedy Express, United Package, Federal Shipping	10 days
6	Meat/Poultry	Chilled	0 to 4 °C	Speedy Express, United Package	5 days
7	Produce	Ambient	Cool and dry	Speedy Express, United Package, Federal Shipping	10 days
8	Seafood	Chilled	0 to 2 °C	Speedy Express only	3 days

Federal Shipping has no temperature-controlled service, so it may never carry chilled goods. Seafood may travel only with Speedy Express, because United Package cannot guarantee delivery within 3 days.

3. Orders with more than one storage class

Northwind ships every order as a single shipment. It does not split an order by storage class. For that reason the strictest line on the order decides the carrier for the whole order.

- An order with at least one Seafood line ships with Speedy Express.
- An order with a Dairy Products or Meat/Poultry line, and no Seafood line, ships with Speedy Express or United Package.
- An order with only ambient lines may ship with any of the three carriers.

4. When the carrier on an order is not allowed

The carrier is recorded on the order in the ShipVia field. When an unshipped order is assigned to a carrier that this guide does not allow, the order must be corrected before it leaves the warehouse.

- 1 Anyone who notices the problem reports it to logistics@northwind.example with the order number.
- 2 Logistics changes the order to the cheapest carrier that this guide allows for it.
- 3 The customer is not charged for the correction, and no approval is needed.

A carrier correction is not an expedite. The Order Expedite and Shipping Policy (NW-POL-002) explains how the two relate.

5. Customer carrier preferences

A customer's preferred carrier is followed only when this guide allows that carrier for the goods on the order. Where the two disagree, this guide wins.

6. Orders shipped before this guide

This guide applies from 1 April 2026. Orders that shipped before that date are not reassessed. Orders that had not shipped on that date must comply before dispatch.

7. Packing

- Chilled goods are packed in insulated boxes with gel packs and leave the cold room no more than 2 hours before the carrier collects them.
- Chilled and ambient goods on the same order are packed in separate boxes inside the same shipment.
- Every box of chilled goods carries the red "Keep chilled" label with the temperature range from the table in section 2.